Faculty Effectiveness Index

Plain-Language Guide for University Management

Purpose: This document explains how the Faculty Effectiveness Index (FEI) is calculated, what each component measures, and how to interpret scores. Written for university leadership — no technical background required.

GRADE REFERENCE

Grade	FEI Score	Meaning
A	**85 – 100**	Exemplary — strong support and student recovery
B	**70 – 84**	Effective — working well with minor gaps
C	**55 – 69**	Developing — weak in one or more areas
D	**40 – 54**	At Risk — major support gaps present
E	**0 – 39**	Critical — support largely absent

Student Early Alert System **Version: June 2026** **Confidential**

SECTION 1

What is the FEI?

The Faculty Effectiveness Index (FEI) is a score from **0 to 100** that answers one question:

> **When the system flags a struggling student, does this faculty actually help them — and do students improve?**

It is **not** a measure of how many students are struggling. A faculty with many alerts is not a bad faculty — it may simply have more at-risk students. The FEI measures **what happens after the flag is raised.**

THE STUDENT SUPPORT JOURNEY

Student Struggles	→	Alert Raised	→	Staff Contact	→	Referral / Resolution	→	Student Recovers
				RESPONSE		WELLBEING		OUTCOME

SECTION 2

The Five Pillars

The FEI is built from five pillars, each measuring a different stage of the student support journey.

Pillar	Weight	One-Line Meaning
Outcome	**30%**	Did students actually improve?
Wellbeing	**25%**	Were students properly supported or referred to professional services?
Response	**25%**	Did staff reach students quickly and follow cases through to conclusion?
Readiness	**10%**	Is attendance data reliable enough to generate trustworthy alerts?
Sustained	**10%**	Is improvement lasting, not just temporary?

FINAL FORMULA

TWO HARD RULES

Rule 1 — Zero Intervention Penalty	If a faculty contacted zero flagged students, FEI cannot exceed 40 (Grade D) regardless of any other score. Detecting a struggling student and doing nothing is a fundamental failure of the system's purpose.
Rule 2 — Coverage Floor	If fewer than 10% of flagged students were contacted, the Response pillar cannot exceed 40, regardless of how quickly or cleanly other response sub-metrics perform.

SECTION 3

The Nine Measurements

Every faculty is measured on nine things. Each is a simple percentage or number of days. **The measurement itself becomes the score** — no translation to arbitrary bands.

Missing Data Rule: If a measurement cannot be calculated (e.g. zero referred students), it scores 50 — neutral. The faculty is neither rewarded nor penalised.

#	Metric	What It Measures & Example	Score Formula
①	**Coverage %**	Of every student the system flagged as at-risk, what percentage did staff actually contact? Example: 73 flagged, 40 contacted → 54.7%	`Score = Coverage % directly`
②	**Critical Coverage %**	Same as Coverage, but only for the most serious (critical) alerts — the highest-risk students. Critical alerts are prioritised separately to ensure urgent cases are not missed.	`Score = Critical Coverage % directly`
③	**Time to First Contact — TTFC (days)**	After a student is flagged, how many days before staff first make contact? Lower is better. Measured as the median across all students. 4 days → score 87 | 14 days → score 53 | 30+ days → score 0	`Score = 100 - (days / 30) x 100`
④	**Conclusion Rate %**	Of students who were contacted, what percentage had their case properly closed? A closed case = Resolved, No Action Required, or Referred to Wellbeing. Example: 73 contacted, 55 concluded → 75.3%	`Score = Conclusion Rate % directly`
⑤	**Wellbeing Uptake %**	Of students whose cases were concluded, how many were also seen by the Wellbeing Centre? Example: 55 concluded, 20 seen by Wellbeing → 36.4%	`Score = Wellbeing Uptake % directly`
⑥	**Recovery %**	Of students who were contacted, how many are no longer showing a warning or critical alert? This is the single most important measurement. Example: 73 contacted, 31 no longer in alert → 42.5%	`Score = Recovery % directly`
⑦	**Repeat Alert %**	Of all flagged students, how many were previously resolved but have fallen back into alert? Lower is better. Example: 159 flagged, 8 repeats = 5% → score 95	`Score = 100 - Repeat Alert %`
⑧	**Stale Cases %**	Of all open interventions, how many have had no update for more than 14 days? Lower is better. Stale = contacted once and forgotten. Example: 156 of 159 open cases stale = 98% → score 2	`Score = 100 - Stale Cases %`
⑨	**Attendance Posting %**	Are teaching staff marking attendance reliably? The alert system depends on this data — if attendance is not posted, alerts cannot fire. Example: 95% of sessions marked → score 95	`Score = Attendance Posting % (maximum 100)`

SECTION 4

How Pillar Scores Are Calculated

Response

25% of FEI

How well staff reach and maintain contact with flagged students.

`avg(Coverage, Critical Coverage, TTFC, Stale Cases)`

Hard rule: if fewer than 10% of flagged students were contacted, Response cannot exceed 40.

Wellbeing

25% of FEI

How well students are supported and handed to professional services.

`avg(Conclusion Rate, Wellbeing Uptake)`

Outcome

30% of FEI

Whether students actually got better — the most heavily weighted pillar.

`(Recovery × 80%) + (Repeat Alert × 20%)`

Recovery carries 80% because it is the most direct evidence a student improved. A high Repeat Alert score alone cannot rescue a faculty with zero recoveries.

Readiness

10% of FEI

Whether attendance data is reliable enough to trust.

`Attendance Posting score`

Sustained

10% of FEI

Whether improvement is lasting. Uses the same formula as Outcome.

`(Recovery × 80%) + (Repeat Alert × 20%)`

Outcome and Sustained are identical in formula. Together they give Recovery + Repeat Alert a combined 40% weight (30% + 10%), reflecting that student recovery is the system's core purpose.

SECTION 5

Worked Example — Social Sciences

Social Sciences has **159 students flagged**, **73 contacted**, **0 cases concluded**, and **0 students recovered**. Here is every step of the calculation.

Step 1 — Raw Counts

Count	Value	Meaning
Students enrolled	**1,541**	Total active students in this faculty
Students alerted	**159**	Students with a warning or critical alert
Students intervened	**73**	Alerted students with any intervention recorded
Cases concluded	**0**	Interventions ending as Resolved / No Action / Referred
Students recovered	**0**	Intervened students no longer in alert
Repeat alerts	**3**	Previously resolved students back in alert
Stale cases	**156**	Open interventions with no update for 14+ days

Step 2 — Each Measurement Becomes a Score

Measurement	Raw Value	Calculation	Score
Coverage %	73÷159=45.91%	Direct	**46**
Critical Coverage %	44.63%	Direct	**45**
TTFC (days)	No history (null)	Null = neutral	**50**
Stale Cases %	156÷159=97.96%	100 – 97.96	**2**
Conclusion Rate %	0÷73=0%	Direct	**0**
Wellbeing Uptake %	0÷0=null	Null = neutral	**50**
Recovery %	0÷73=0%	Direct	**0**
Repeat Alert %	3÷159=1.89%	100 – 1.89	**98**
Attendance Posting %	119.39% → cap 100	min(119.39, 100)	**100**

Step 3 — Pillar Scores

Pillar	Calculation	Score
Response	`avg(46, 45, 50, 2) = 35.75`	**36**
Wellbeing	`avg(0, 50) = 25`	**25**

Outcome	(0 × 80%) + (98 × 20%) = 19.6	**20**
Readiness	100	**100**
Sustained	(0 × 80%) + (98 × 20%) = 19.6	**20**

Step 4 — Final FEI

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(20 × 30%) + (25 × 25%) + (36 × 25%) + (100 × 10%) + (20 × 10%)
= 6.0 + 6.25 + 9.0 + 10.0 + 2.0 = 33.25
```

33
Grade E

Critical
A faculty with 0% conclusions, 0% recovery, and 98% stale cases is correctly classified as Critical. The score of 33 reflects exactly that — zero wellbeing follow-through cannot be hidden by attendance data or low repeat alerts.

SECTION 6

What a Grade A Faculty Looks Like

The metric levels a faculty would need to achieve an Exemplary (A) grade.

Metric	Target for Grade A
Coverage %	90% or more of flagged students contacted
TTFC	Within 3 days of the alert being raised
Conclusion Rate %	75% or more of cases properly closed (Resolved / No Action / Referred)
Wellbeing Uptake %	70% or more of concluded cases also seen by the Wellbeing Centre
Recovery %	60% or more of contacted students clear their alert
Stale Cases %	Less than 10% of open cases left without update for 14+ days
Repeat Alert %	Less than 5% of students return to alert after resolution

SECTION 7

Key Things to Remember

High alerts do not mean a bad faculty. A faculty with 2,000 alerts may simply have more at-risk students. The FEI only measures what happens after the alert is raised, not how many alerts exist.

The score is the number. A Coverage score of 46 means 46% of students were reached — not a band, not a category. Every percentage point of real improvement moves the FEI.

Recovery drives everything. At 40% combined weight (Outcome 30% + Sustained 10%), whether students actually clear their alert is the dominant signal. Fast response and good attendance data cannot compensate for zero recoveries.

Stale cases are the most visible quick win. Closing or updating open interventions costs little effort but immediately moves the Stale score, which feeds directly into Response at 25% of FEI.

The referral and resolution pipeline matters. Conclusion Rate and Wellbeing Uptake form the Wellbeing pillar (25%). If staff are not closing cases or referring students, this pillar will be near zero regardless of response speed.

Scores refresh daily. The system recomputes all scores overnight. Improvements made today appear in tomorrow's dashboard.

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FEI = (Outcome × 30%) + (Wellbeing × 25%) + (Response × 25%) + (Readiness × 10%) + (Sustained × 10%)
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